

4. Meals: Setting ISF_weights in /Preferences

V.5.8.1



Please note that with autoISF you are in an early-dev. environment,

where the user interface is **not optimized for safety** of users who stray away from intended ways to use. Good safety features exist, but these are only as good as the development-oriented user understands and implements them. This is not a medical product, refer to disclaimer in [section 0](#)

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[Available related case studies:](#)

[Case study 4.1: Pizza](#)

[Case study 4.2: Low carb meal](#)

[Case study 4.3: Hands-off FCL on Xmas](#)

[Available supporting Excel sheets](#) (to download on PC)

[04_ISF_weights_effects...xls](#)

4.1 Getting started

Caution: This entire e-book is about Full Closed Looping (FCL).

In case you intend to work with giving boli, many suggestions made - notably in this [section 4](#), and in [section 2](#) – should **not** be followed.

You should then primarily use the autoISF Quick Guide (from <https://github.com/ga-zelle/autoISF>), and **do extra research**, on your own data. (Look at the chart in [section 4.1.2](#) - your bolus very much would change things there!).

If you shy away, for now, from FCL, please have a look into sections discussing methods with “**Meal Announcement**”, [section 07](#), and [section 13.3](#)-

4.1.1 Reminder of pre-requisites

This section 4. is about the core FCL aspects of autoISF. Before doing anything with this section, please make sure you have studied the preceding [sections 1](#) and [2](#) on the general pre-requisites for FCL and the developers “Quick guide” (see [section 3](#)) on the principal workings of autoISF.

Core points are briefly summarized below.

Start with proper “safety” settings

Before you start tuning your autoISF for FCL, **make sure you have** appropriately:

- **widened the SMB size restrictions** ([section 2.1](#)),
- **elevated** the max allowed ISF amplification via your set **autoISFmax** ([section 2.2](#))

Both of these points are extremely important: If you set (or keep in place) narrow restrictions, this will **not** allow to see effects from a more aggressively tuned ISF. Even worse, it would cover-up too aggressive settings (e.g. on the ..._ISF_weights that we get to in a moment), and invariably make your loop bounce against the restriction(s).

This could even work fine, if your meal spectrum isn't broad: If, in your HCL, the **same** bolus size pretty much fitted all your meals, it could now, in FCL, be replaced by rushing, with super-aggressively modulated ISFs, into the set restrictions, to produce - with only a brief delay – the required iob that would be about equivalent to what you formerly had bolussed in your HCL.

A system that is really fit **for the variance** we all like to enjoy in our daily lives, though, would be characterized by “tolerating” pretty wide open safety restrictions*), while having cautiously calibrated other, notably ISF modulating, parameters (as described in [sections 4.2 – 4.5](#)).

*) Still, for safety (as also suggested in section 2.1 and 2.2), start your tuning on a middle ground, and only gradually widen SMB size and autoISFmax during your initial tuning.

80 Also make sure you have

- 81 • **set your iobTH%** (refer to [section 2.4](#))

82

83 Furthermore, in your early test phase, it is recommended to:

- 84 • Run the system as dummy, not connected to your body (or, on own risk, connect only as long
85 as you watch closely)
- 86 • In AAPS preferences, switch your autoISF FCL (= **autoISF/”Enable adaptation of ISF to
87 glucose behavior”**) ON only during daytime hours of a meal, e.g. *11-18h*, for fully automatic
88 “full closed loop” management *of lunches*.

89 You can do this switching manually *at 11 h and 18 h every day*, or set up an
90 Automation that does that (see [section 3.4](#)).

91 Take **typical but not extreme** meals. Omit sweet drinks, or drink only slowly. You are going for a
92 “good enough” compromise, that works with your range of usual meals.

93

94 **It is wasted time to do a lot of iterations to “optimize” settings based on just 1 type of meal.**

95 See [case study 8.2](#)

96

97 Occasionally, watch the time-pattern of bg, iob (SMBs given), and insulin activity after meal start.

98 Aside from serious “mathematical” attempts to tune settings based on data from the AUTO ISF tab

99 (eventually aided by the Excel sheets in [04_ISF_weights_effects...xls](#), or by the Emulator, [section](#)

100 [10](#)), just watching the curves develop on your AAPS main screen can, over time, give you “a feel”

101 what settings, and eating behaviors, are benign or detrimental to good %TIR performance.

102

103 [Importance of proper profile ISFs.](#)

104

105 Starters on autoISF FCL who are coming from using HCL with **dynamicISF** must be aware of the

106 following: It is absolutely essential to build your FCL on a properly set **profile** ISFs (likely a

107 circadian pattern over 24 hrs). See also the red box in [section 4.3.2](#)!

108

109 It may not apply to you, but many dynamicISF users did never bother to determine their ISFs that
110 would maximize their HCL performance, but employ dynamicISF so to speak for going

111 „dynamically“ through a wide range of possible ISFs, until eventually hitting a sweet spot, and the

112 whole thing works better than before, with what they had *used* as a profile ISF (often only one, e.g.

113 coming from Autotune).

114

115 The following is important to understand, as it leads straight into the core idea behind FCL with
116 autoISF, too: It is a good idea to establish a well-running hybrid closed loop with set (non-dynamic)
117 **ISF** (set in **profile** for each hour of the day). That ISF must be **aggressive enough** that it gets you
118 down from a high around 200 mg/dl to target. That is roughly also the way you experimentally
119 determined it (so I hope. See “ISF determination....pdf” in: [https://github.com/bernie4375/HCL-](https://github.com/bernie4375/HCL-Meal-Mgt.-ISF-and-IC-settings)
120 [Meal-Mgt.-ISF-and-IC-settings](https://github.com/bernie4375/HCL-Meal-Mgt.-ISF-and-IC-settings))

- 121 • Using *that strong* value also *at lower bg*, (on the way “up” , after meal start), is very positive:
122 We do *not* want to have a *softer* acting loop when at *lower bg* (which is what dynamicISF
123 tends to do!). autoISF will, in contrast, temporarily sharpen your ISF when, at low bg,
124 acceleration is detected..
- 125 • On the way down from peak, towards glucose target, a somewhat too strong ISF should not
126 hurt because much of the time your loop (well supplied with insulin before, „on the way up“)
127 is zero temping , or at least has only a small gap to correct, from predicted bg to target bg.
- 128 • You have no business to be much above 200 mg/dl where an *even stronger ISF* may or
129 may not help. It sure does not help at an occlusion which is about the only reason to see
130 super high values as an experienced looper.

131

132 **Pegging ISF strength to bg level** therefore **does not make sense in FCL**. You will use the
133 autoISF toolbox to get strongest ISF **at low** but beginning-to-rise bg,

134

135 Note: There are very much refined versions of dynamicISF that can have beneficial applications,
136 notably in HCL ...And, yes, I know, bg levels can also correlate with insulin sensitivity. But let us not
137 get into “chicken or egg type” discussions.

138 Rather, focus on doing a good tuning job, and use superior approaches to account for sensitivity
139 changes in a more pro-active manner (before running into sky-high bg (or into hypos)):

140

141 Going to autoISF FCL, you absolutely must **anchor on the proper profile_ISF**.

- 142 • See also the red box in [section 4.3.2!](#)

143

144 The profile is not “set in stone”, though. Pegging ISF strength to your **current insulin sensitivity** –
145 very much like you had done all along in HCL - **does make sense** also in your FCL...

146 (...and the fact that autoISF afterwards “anyways” often strongly modifies ISF is not a reasonable
147 counter-argument).

148

149 There are fully automated, as well as manual ways for **sensitivity adaptations of the profile ISF**:

150

151 Profile ISFs can get **fully automatically adapted**, e.g. by Autosens, or by the Activity Monitor,
152 which in autoISF we rather use ([section 6.5](#)).

153 Which of your basic related settings (in AAPS/Preferences) produce exactly which adaptation can
154 be seen right in the top lines of your AUTO ISF tab (SMB tab in earlier versions) of AAPS, at each
155 loop decision. Likewise, it can be retrieved later in logfile analysis (see Emulator, [section 10](#))

156

157 Furthermore, when using autoISF you can – as you did in the past, e.g. around exercise, or in
158 times of illness – temporarily **manually modify** your profile ISFs

159

160 Also these effects are quantified in AUTO ISF tab and logfiles *).

161 *) Furthermore, the results from autoISF are explained in the AUTO ISF tab, and multiplied with (original or
162 adjusted) profile ISF to result in the ISF (called “sens”) used in the current insulinRequired calculation

163

164 All three top buttons in AAPS (%profile switch, exercise and TT) can be freely used to adapt to
165 changes in sensitivity/resistance, turning into a yellow color to alert you to this. (More about your
166 “FCL cockpit” see [section 5.2.2.](#)).

167

168 For a start, please spend a couple of days (if not weeks) to **get your key autoISF related settings**
169 **right**, strictly **on/for days with your normal insulin sensitivity**. This is what this [section 4](#) is
170 about.

171

172 [Importance of starting from a well-performing Hybrid Closed Loop](#)

173

174 A **satisfying performance in Hybrid Closed Loop** mode is a pre-requisite. Expect to reproduce
175 about the same %TIR also in your FCL, but with less daily interaction, once established.

176 Note that this refers to prior use of „vanilla“ software, without fancy „dynamic add-ons“ (such as:
177 Autotune determined factors, dynamicISF etc). that may have introduced bias into the profile
178 settings you bring with you into FCL now.

179

180 To reach a satisfying performance you must start from a hybrid closed loop in which you did
181 **master your meal management well** using theoref(1) algo SMB+UAM.

182 This is a pre-requisite **to be able to forget it** ... - because the initial tuning that we now turn to
183 demands, that you analyze your **prior best practice as your blueprint** to find appropriate settings
184 and „teach“ your FCL to come up with the necessary job.

185

186 This is the main subject of this section 4 (finding settings for automatic meal management).

187

188

189 Do not copy settings from other FCL loopers

190
191 When setting your parameters, don't use any given numerical example (not even as “a starting
192 point”). Instead, anchor on **data from your *successful* Hybrid Closed Loop!**

193
194 Most *examples given in this paper* are from an adult diabetic (Lyumjev, G6) whose insulin sensitivity
195 can be characterized as follows: approximately 37 U TDD, thereof 13 U profile basal, at about 200g
196 daily carbs from mainly lunch and dinner; no couch snacks or sweet drinks. The user also
197 participates in multiple instances of daily moderate exercise such as dog walking, biking and
198 gardening. In Hybrid Closed Loop, a typical meal bolus was 8 U that was sometimes reduced such
199 as when activity followed the meal.

200 After seeing some more inputs from a variety of users we might put together a profile helper for
201 some rough orientation, and for plausibility cross-checking, in [section 4.8](#)

202
203 Importance of going step-by-step

204
205 [Section 5](#) will explore avenues to manage “disturbances”, i.e. time blocks or situations that might
206 demand enhanced or reduced loop aggressiveness.

207 [Section 6](#) will focus on the exercise mode, and the activity monitor.

208 In case you have a strong interest in the Activity monitor ([section 6.6](#)), you can start with
209 calibrating that, and have it run already in the weeks when you go through sections 4 and 5.
210 In case you use an EatingSoonTT at meal start (the author recommends to try without), note that any
211 active TT shuts activity monitor automatically off while that TT is active.

212
213 Resist the temptation to make use of the tools presented in sections 5 and 6 too early.

214 On your **first** setting-up and tuning attempt, **it is strongly recommended that you not “play**
215 **around” with all ultimately available features, but stick to the sequence of steps to take.**

216
217 Yes, “playing around” with the many extra buttons often will help find an improvement. But you
218 likely create an instable FCL that, already at fairly standard situations, uses up some of your FCL's
219 principal capacity to correct for disturbances. This limits what will be left to manage extreme
220 situations.

221
222 Caution: **Once you created a maze of little errors and counter-strategies/counter-errors, it will be**
223 **nearly impossible to find your way** out of this mess, **towards better settings**, at any later point of time.

224
225 Note that it is principally not easy to conclude on suitability of tuning:

226 • AutoISF comes with very many (currently 18) extra parameters, and even when employing the
227 emulator ([sections 10](#) and [11](#)), it is quite hard to analyze their interaction.

228 One principal reason why things are difficult to analyze is, that you really can only analyze one
229 decision, and that will put you on another bg curve. So, you can never see the full effect, along more
230 than half an hour or so, that *any* change would really result in.

231

232 • Understandably, many loopers rather “move forward” to an over-patch for identified problems, and
233 not bother with a more “puristic” step-by-step approach to do things right from the ground up.

234 • Aware of above sketched conundrum, the AAPS autoISF developers offer the ultimate tool to
235 investigate “what-if”, regarding a setting change you may contemplate: A nice lady voice on your
236 smartphone can tell you, at each loop decision, where your contemplated change would make a
237 difference (in SMB size). This offers an opportunity to watch closely, with or without implementing
238 that change. (It is always your spontaneous choice, whether you want to “follow the lady’s
239 suggestion and manually add to the SMB, as suggested). More see in [Section 11.4](#)

240 But, we are getting ahead too far here. You first must find a starting point for key settings, which works
241 reasonably for not too-challenging meals in your personal spectrum.

242 Before getting into this, let’s first have a look on how autoISF basically works. (More see in Quick guide by
243 the developer, referenced in [section 3.2](#); or directly at <https://github.com/ga-zelle/autoISF>).

244

245 [4.1.2 autoISF factors overview in typical glucose chart](#)

246

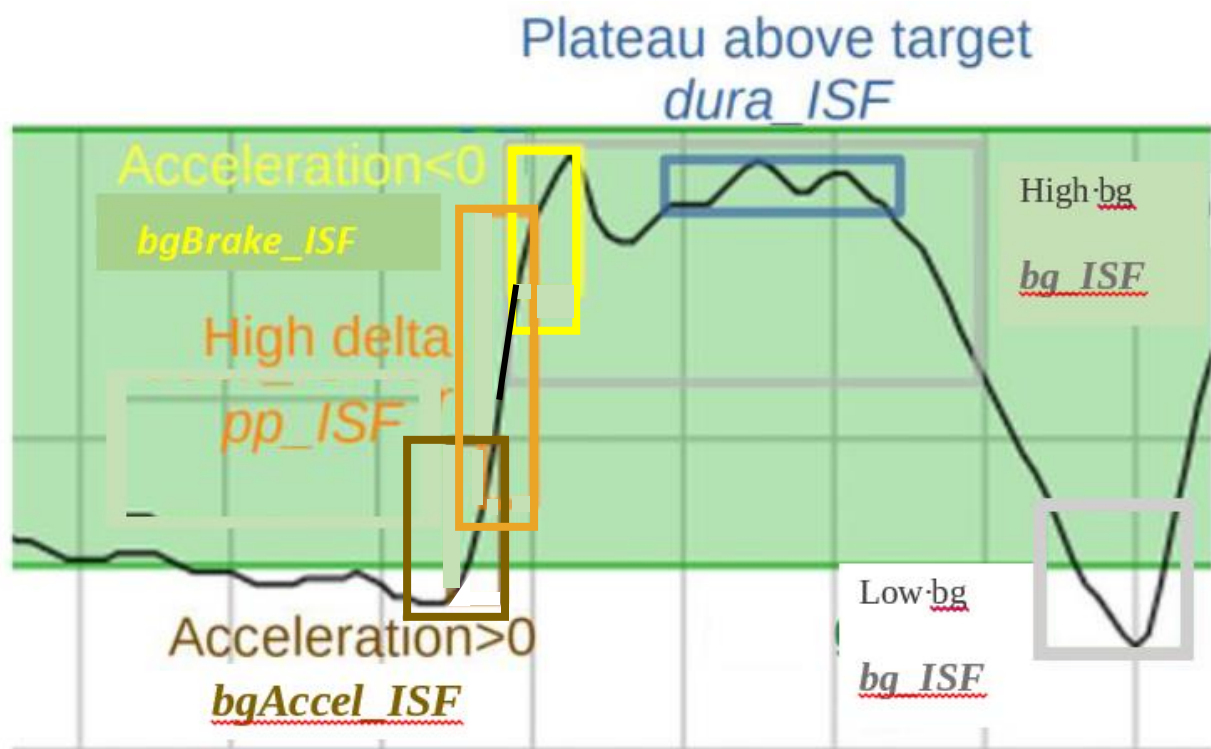
247 The core challenge of your UAM Full Closed Loop is to recognize a meal start from the glucose
248 trend, and ramping up iob.

249

250 When setting up your autoISF Full Closed Loop, **you must set several ISF_weight parameters**
251 **in AAPS Preferences/OpenAPS SMB/autoISF settings.**

252

253 They relate to different stages of the typical glucose curve after starting a meal:



Note: **bg_ISF** is not used much in FCL, as it is rather late to act on high (or low) bg level that developed. But, feel free to experiment, e.g. in case you have indications, in your data, that in the past dynamicISF was useful to manage bg extremes in some situations.

The core advantage of using autoISF withoref(1) SMB+UAM (in FCL as well as in hybrid closed loop) is that it manages the glucose curve it sees developing, **no matter what the underlying reason** is.

42 potential factors were identified (see: <https://github.com/bernie4375/HCL-Meal-Mgt.-ISF-and-IC-settings/blob/FCL-w/autoISF/42%20factors%20influence%20bg.pdf>), so, no wonder, that loopers who meticulously input their carbs will often *not* see the expected result.

In case you like to learn more about the theoretical background for the autoISF development, here some core aspects the key developer shared in a DIY forum:

Theory behind autoISF

gazelle, Aug. 2024

I have recently managed to work through the large pile of older (German) diabetes journals. I've now reached issue 5/2024 and was amazed by the article "How insulin is produced and works in the body".

According to the article, there are essentially 2 phases of release:

- Phase (1) lasts only a few minutes and releases a large dose from the beta cell's supply when glucose rises.
- (2) After that, insulin is newly produced and released evenly over a period of hours.

These two phases remind me very much of initial *acce_ISF* and later *dura_ISF* in autoISF.

This may explain why it works so well for many users. I had no idea about this process in the body when I developed both effects.

1. *acce_ISF* was based on **Newton's 2nd law of mechanics**, i.e. inertial mass * acceleration = force.
For me, this meant that when the FC is accelerated, a "sweet force" is acting.
To counteract this, the acceleration must be counteracted.
Strengthening the ISF, i.e. increasing resistance, corresponds to an increase in inertial mass, so to speak.
2. *dura_ISF* was an analogy to the **PID controller** in technology:
P stands for proportional control, in this case the deviation of the FC from the target value;
I stands for integral of the deviation, in this case the sum of the deviation from the target;
D stands for differential control, in this case the delta of the BG.

The components for P and D are contained in the regular AAPS, but the I component was missing. So I added it, as a rough approximation, using dura_ISF.

*I find it very interesting that both solutions came about from analogies to technology/mechanics without direct knowledge of **hormone metabolism**. I have always been interested in using analogies to transfer solutions to other fields.
Translated with DeepL.com (free version)*

Remark: This just broadbrush sketches the general idea. Lots of dev work had unfortunately to go into details, like how to deal with everyday imperfections of our CGM systems, and still come up with meaningful mathematical (parabola fit) earliest-possible detection of "real" bg rises.

4.1.3 Getting ready to set your autoISF_weights

Before you progress, make sure you studied the flowcharts in [section 3](#) that describe how autoISF calculates the **effective**(ly used) ISF.

Warning: Any bolus you „sneak in“ will severely distort the glucose curve. That could render your tuning of weights (see below) useless, and could **make your loop act in unpredictable ways** (potentially also dangerous, however, your set iobTH ([section 2.4](#)) should help here, too).

In case you feel tempted to use boli, be ready for some own extra research, and refer to [section 7](#).

After doing the prep work as outlined in [section 2](#) you now get to calibrate your FCL to your **normal meal spectrum** by initially **setting and tuning the various _ISF_weights**, that dynamically change with bg curve characteristics as sketched in the chart on the previous page.

Please stay away from extremes (regarding both, meals and exercise) **when you go through this [section 4](#)**. It is about getting a first *roughly right* set of settings, as a basis.

Researching your standard meal patterns, and finding settings for the various _ISF_weights is the core job in setting up your autoISF FCL.

Depending how varied your diet and general lifestyle are (and your expectation of %TIR you like to reach), this could be the main job at hand. However, there is much more you *could do later*, and that will be outlined in later sections 5 and 6.

Consult sometimes your AUTO ISF tab, to see how the applied effective ISF (named **sens** there) is calculated. (Example given in [section 5.3.6](#)).

4.2 Meal detection and managing the initial bg rise: bgAccel_ISF

4.2.1 Mimicking a HCL bolus in FCL using bgAccel_ISF

When looping without carb inputs and without giving a bolus ourselves, the first crucial setting is to set the **bgAccel_ISF_weight** so that SMBs are requested immediately when the loop detects an acceleration in your blood glucose (bg) that is starting to rise.

Ideally **within about 20 minutes after acceleration detection, which would be the first up to 4 SMBs, as much iob should automatically be supplied as we would have given with our bolus in hybrid closed loop.**

As the biggest principal challenge for the FCL is big **high/fast carb** meals (from within your personal “spectrum”), we start with a focus to get sufficiently big SMBs going for those.

Note, though, that in a **low carb** meal scenario, the first 4 SMBs would have to automatically result much smaller (which, after careful tuning, is possible with the same parameter settings, see e.g. [case studies 4.2 vs 4.3](#)).

Rule of thumb: Two of the first three SMBs each (in this test based on a big meal) should be about ¼ to 1/3 the size of a bolus in your HCL „career“ (for a similar meal).

Going over 1/3 could be problematic

- if your diet contains occasional **low carb** (or brief **snacking**), it is not helpful if your settings make your loop invariably “bounce” over your iobTH (and then you would need extra snacks to balance the auto-generated iob, to prevent hypos),
- also if your **CGM quality** is sometimes unreliable, and might produce an artefact that could be mistaken for a meal start.

Be vigilant about this topic! And please do not choose the supposedly easy way, to just set safety restrictions (allowed max SMB size, or autoISFmax) so low, that your loop never can exceed 1/3. Try to really tune the _ISF_weights appropriately. (Only that way, your loop can “accommodate” the entire meal spectrum, and also states of adapted general insulin sensitivity).

4.2.2 Widened safety restrictions

Already when tuning the bgAccel_ISF_weight it can become evident that safety restrictions (as discussed in [section 2](#)) must be **widened** further:

- 361 • Especially if your *profile basal* rate is very small, the **smb_max_range_extention** and/or
362 the **autoISF_max** "must" often be increased further.
- 363 • Pay attention also to the **iobTH%** and, potentially, iobMAX
- 364 • Note that the smb_delivery_ratio "only" portions the insulinReq differently over the next 15
365 minutes (see also [section 2.3](#)), and therefore is **not** a prime tuning parameter.

366 In the end you should **not set these safety limits too tight**, so "nudging" aggressiveness by
367 another 10 or 20% from your cockpit, later, will not bounce into restrictions.

368

369 On the other hand, setting **narrower** restrictions for max allowed SMB size can also become
370 necessary:

- 371 • Poorer CGM quality demands narrower restrictions for safety reasons.
- 372 • If you use a 1-minute CGM, please observe [section 1.4.2](#)

373

374 [4.2.3 Start value for your bgAccel_ISF tuning](#)

375

376 bgAccel_ISF_weight is set default to zero in AAPS Preferences/SMB/autoISF.

377 **To start**, I would try 0.05 or **max 0.1**, and keep trying in max 0.05 steps. Soon move to 0.02 steps.
378 From my (very limited) overview, many use around 0.2, and possibly even higher. Do not be
379 tempted to rush this setting by using large jumps in adjustments. **Do not include days with bad**
380 **CGM performance** (see next chapter, red box).

381 Closely monitor what is happening. In search of appropriate settings, you must keep track of
382 when/how autoISF actually "translates" your set bgAccel_ISF_weight into a sizeable SMB:

383

- 384 • To do this in the **AUTO ISF tab** is possible but not very practical. You would end up making
385 a lot of screenshots (quickly in the crucial minutes after a SMB was given, or when you
386 *thought it should be* given), for later analysis.
- 387 • The superior method is to just copy **logfiles** from your phone/internal
388 memory/AAPS/logs ...

389 ○ all zip files there

390 ○ look up how many days of data are covered there on a rolling basis, and copy out
391 onto your PC (see [section 10.1.1](#)) before the older ones get forever lost

392 ... and analyze them at your convenience later, using

- 393 ○ the **Emulator** (see [section 10](#); used e.g. in last pages of [case study 4.2](#))
- 394 ○ the [acce](#) subsheet in: [04_ISF_weights_effects...xls](#)

- Some emulator-based analysis is also possible within AAPS on your phone ([section-11](#)).

In any case, it is worth the effort to tune the **bgAccel_ISF_weight** in such a way that high glucose increases are already nipped in the bud, so to speak.

To summarize: In FCL, the first 3 or 4 SMBs should not be much delayed, and amount to similar job like your “former boli in HCL”.

Depending on details about the carb absorption characteristics of your meal, and the performance of your CGM, also **pp_ISF** (see [section 4.3](#)) might be a fairly early contributor to getting job up.

4.2.4 How changing the _weights influences the resulting calculated insulinRequired

(If you “hate math” and rather go in cautious “trial and error steps” for your tuning, you can skip this section).

The developers’ documentation (Quick Guide) https://github.com/ga-zelle/autolSF/blob/A3.2.0.4_ai3.0.1/autolSF3.0.1_Quick_Guide.pdf gives the following equation:

acce_ISF is the factor by which autolSF wants to sharpen the profile ISF in a certain situation of bg acceleration:

acce_ISF is calculated by

$$\text{acce_ISF} = 1 + \text{acce_weight} * \text{fit_share} * \text{cap_weight} * \text{acceleration} \quad (\text{eq.1})$$

where **fit_share** a measure of fit quality, i.e. 0% if unacceptable up to 100% if perfect;
cap_weight is 0.5 below target and 1.0 otherwise;
acce_weight is bgAccel_ISF_weight for acceleration away from target, i.e. mostly positive
or bgBrake_ISF_weight for acceleration towards target, i.e. mostly negative

fit_share should be close to 1.0 (at good CGM quality).

As you see from the parameter fit_share included in eq.1, your CGM quality will interfere, and can (1) strongly “soften” the loop response you intended to have or even (2) not give you a SMB at all, but delay the so much needed first SMB after meal start in FCL.

You have 3 basic options to deal with this:

- 1) Use a well-performing CGM. Recommendation is overlapping 2xG6, or upfront (before your FCL tuning) invest time into figuring out best smoothing, and which body sites, or sensor days, are your “good ones”.
- 2) Do your tuning strictly on days that are “your good ones” re. CGM. That will give you best-possible performance, and there will also be no need to re-tune should you solve your CGM problem later.
- 3) Just “live with the CGM you have”. To reasonably average all influencing factors into your tuning, this means you need to collect more data (from days within the “spectrum” of your CGM performance). And it will result in a loop where SMBs on average come later or weaker. As they tend to be weaker, you will be tempted to tune towards stronger acce_weights → which will backfire on “good CGM days” → and lead to an overall higher tuning effort with resulting smaller “dynamic range” and lower %TIR.

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Having a EatingSoonTT at first acceleration *can help* avoid the factor **iF** getting cut in half!
 “Preferred solution” to do this via an Automation, see FCL e-book [section 2.5](#)

$$\text{profile_ISF} / \text{acce_ISF} = \text{effectively used ISF (sens)}$$

(...if the acce influence dominates and is used as effective ISF. Else, see flowcharts in Quick Guide)

When looking at the same acceleration moment, we can combine all three last factors of eq.1 into a term “ $\mathbf{iF}$ ”.

For estimating the effect from using another ISF_weight, we then have two (eq.1) , with two unknowns, α (“cancelling out”), and the sought α_{ISF} (for new_weight).

Example: Your profile_ISF is 40 mg/dl/U. Using bgAccel_ISF_weight of 0.2

you saw effectively used ISF of 30.3 mg/dl/U (box C13 in table below) = $40 / 1.32$

=> factor for acce_ISF = 1.32.

For an intended correction by -10 mg/dl the insulinRequired would calculate to $10 / 30.3 = 0.330$ U.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
1	Profil ISF (mg/dl/U)	40		bgAccel_ISF tuning -				
2	InsReq (U) @ iF=0	1		see FCL e-Book section 4.2.4				
3	bgAccel_ISF_weight:	0,2			0,1			InsReq effect
4	iF	acce ISF old	ISF old	InsReq old	acce ISF new	ISF new	InsReq new	
5	0	1	40	1	1	40	1	0%
6	0,2	1,04	38,5	1,04	1,02	39,2	1,02	-2%
7	0,4	1,08	37,0	1,08	1,04	38,5	1,04	-4%
8	0,6	1,12	35,7	1,12	1,06	37,7	1,06	-5%
9	0,8	1,16	34,5	1,16	1,08	37,0	1,08	-7%
10	1	1,2	33,3	1,2	1,1	36,4	1,1	-8%
11	1,2	1,24	32,3	1,24	1,12	35,7	1,12	-10%
12	1,4	1,28	31,3	1,28	1,14	35,1	1,14	-11%
13	1,6	1,32	30,3	1,32	1,16	34,5	1,16	-12%
14	1,8	1,36	29,4	1,36	1,18	33,9	1,18	-13%
15	2	1,4	28,6	1,4	1,2	33,3	1,2	-14%
16	2,2	1,44	27,8	1,44	1,22	32,8	1,22	-15%
17	2,4	1,48	27,0	1,48	1,24	32,3	1,24	-16%
18	2,6	1,52	26,3	1,52	1,26	31,7	1,26	-17%
19	2,8	1,56	25,6	1,56	1,28	31,3	1,28	-18%
20	3	1,6	25,0	1,6	1,3	30,8	1,3	-19%
21	3,2	1,64	24,4	1,64	1,32	30,3	1,32	-20%
22	3,4	1,68	23,8	1,68	1,34	29,9	1,34	-20%
23	3,6	1,72	23,3	1,72	1,36	29,4	1,36	-21%
24	3,8	1,76	22,7	1,76	1,38	29,0	1,38	-22%
25	4	1,8	22,2	1,8	1,4	28,6	1,4	-22%
26	4,2	1,84	21,7	1,84	1,42	28,2	1,42	-23%
27	4,4	1,88	21,3	1,88	1,44	27,8	1,44	-23%
28	4,6	1,92	20,8	1,92	1,46	27,4	1,46	-24%
29	4,8	1,96	20,4	1,96	1,48	27,0	1,48	-24%
30	5	2	20	2	1,5	26,7	1,5	-25%

formula (line 30) =1+\$A30*\$B\$3 =B\$1/B30 =+\$B\$2*\$B\$1/C30 =1+\$A30*\$E\$3 =B\$1/E30 =+\$B\$2*\$B\$1/F30 "=G30/D30-1

Note: To determine not the incremental effect between two weights (E3 vs.B3), but the acc ISF effect

for the investigated weight (E3): Enter 0 in (B3)

Column (H) then shows the full effect of acce ISF with the selected weight (E3)

Now, going with a 50% reduced bgAccel_ISF_weight of 0.10:

$$\text{acce_ISF} = 1 + \text{bgAccel_ISF_weight} * \text{internalFactor}$$

before $1,32 = 1 + 0.20 * iF \Rightarrow 0.32 = 0.20 * iF \Rightarrow iF = 1.60$ (see box A13)

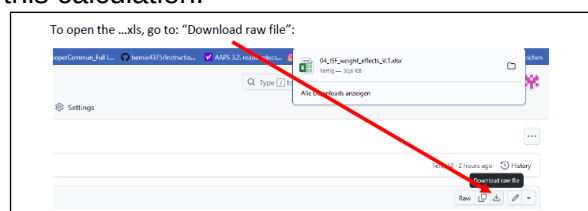
after $? = 1 + 0.10 * iF \Rightarrow ? = 1 + 0.10 * 1.6 = 1.16$

New effective ISF would be $40 / 1.16 = 34.48$ mg/dl/U (box F13).

For an intended correction by -10 mg/dl the **insulinRequired** would now calculate to $10 / 34.48 = 0.290$ U, which is **12 % less** (H13).

At higher acceleration points of the bg curve (column A, line 14 and higher), the effects would be more pronounced (column H, line 14 and higher).

An **Excel tool** is provided in e-book section 04 for this calculation.



Never forget to look into how other .._ISFs play into the effective ISF (named **sens** in the AUTO ISF tab), which overall results.

However, easier to handle for you might be the simple “trial and error” approach already discussed in the preceding [section 4.2.1](#) where, to get a feel for how changing the _weights influences the resulting calculated insulinRequired, you cautiously **do 10 to max 20% steps up, and watch out for the effects**. Doing similar step sizes should yield about similar effects each time.

4.2.5 Characteristics of a well tuned-in bgAccel_ISF_weight

Your starting point was to set the bgAccel_ISF_weight so FCL works in a rather high carb meal.

Now you must check (and potentially fine tune) so it **will not “shoot iob too high”** with the first 3 or 4 SMBs **in other meals from your spectrum**:

- For meals that are in the **lower** (!) range of the "fast **carb load**" of your cluster, the necessary insulin supply for the first two hours or so might pretty much be provided already with the first 3 or 4 SMBs

The glucose curve, at such meals, begins to flatten early in this SMB phase, so a deceleration (**braking**) follows very soon (-> [section 4.4](#)). Clearly, the first 3 SMBs, in such cases, must remain below iobTH.

- **Low carb** meals are principally easiest for the FCL. However, you must secure that your bgAccel_ISF driven **first SMBs** remain small. This is principally possible also with a fairly aggressive bgAccel_ISF_weight set, because both acceleration and initial deltas are small when eating low carb. (Regarding the detected acceleration, the stakes may be high for the CGM and smoothing method you chose).
- A stage where moderate amounts of carb absorption and of insulin usage/need hold a balance could protract – at moderate bg elevation -over hours. The **dura_ISF** might play a bigger role, then, as e.g. in the low carb example in [case study 4.2](#).

In case you run into limitations, see next sub-chapter.

4.2.6 Suitability for many types of meal

For a **hands-off FCL**, your settings have to fit

- **in each** of your **meal times**

What helps here is that, *between* your daily mealtime slots, your **circadian profile ISFs** (upon which the autoISF modulations build) automatically make a differentiation (as was the case in your HCL).

- for the whole **range of your meals**. All this is principally possible, but: ...

What if you still have meals that you cannot make fit?

In extreme cases you will have to balance too high running iob with additional carbs (a late additional snack against going too low), and in the opposite case, you will have to reckon with temporarily exceeding the glucose target range, and losing some %TIR for this day.

If your meals vary very strongly, there are **avenues to ease your initial tuning job, or to optimize overall resulting loop performance:**

- Automations allow you to differentiate. For instance it is possible to apply different iobTH_percent and/or different bgAccel_ISF_weights for meals in different **time windows** or geo locations (details see [sections 3.4](#) and [5.1](#))

In case you use autoISF on the Trio or iAPS platform for i-phones, you may need to use a third party automation software, or “middleware” (! [call for a case study 4.X](#))

- you can pre-program **custom buttons for special** meal (or snack) **types**, with different underlying FCL settings (see “cockpit”, [section 5.2.2.3](#))

- You can **modulate FCL aggressiveness manually** making use of the top 3 buttons in the AAPS home screen: These turn yellow during temporary switched %profile or glucose target ([section 5.2.2.2](#))

Experimenting with the three above mentioned “avenues”, the author found:

- the last point easiest to occasionally use, and the first one hardest.
- it worth investing some effort (also using the emulator a couple of times) to iterate through the typical meal spectrum a couple of times, for finding a “good enough” set of .._ISF_weights and other settings (like autoISFmax, iobTH% etc), *and **not do much extra differentiation***. (More see in [section 5](#)).

4.2.7 Summary on tuning for the initial SMBs via bgAccel_ISF

Early strong iob also will **ease the tuning task for the subsequent phases** of the meal, because there is, then, largely zero-temping (as well known from HCL-times after your administered bolus). Also, the lower and shorter lasting the glucose peak, the lesser the hypo danger from the activity tail of SMBs given *when* glucose was „stuck“ high.

However, it is important **not too super-aggressively** tune bgAccel_ISF_weight up, so, regardless of the type of meal, very big SMBs invariably would result.

Rather, the rough idea should be:

- SMBs driven by bgAccel_ISF: initial iob for **all meals**. SMB sizes vary, because accelerations and deltas vary.

So, at high carb meals it depends on your settings, and on the evolving bg curve, whether the first few bgAccel_ISF driven SMBs get you already up to iobTH in high carb meals, or whether this happens in the *overlapping* next stage.

So, looking a bit ahead to the next chapters:

- SMBs driven by pp_ISF: to the extent there is strong (near-linear) bg rise (at **big meals rich in carbs**) with big or small deltas, iob is now driven towards (and potentially over) iobTH.

In low carb meals this period can be extremely short, with iob remaining under iobTH (example see [case study 4.2](#))

- 554 • SMBs driven by bgBrake_ISF, bg_ISF, or dura_ISF:

555 Note that *all of these* can overlap with the pp_ISF stage. Consult the csv table output
556 from the Emulator (example given at end of [case study 4.2](#)) as to which of the _ISF
557 categories drives the effectively used ISF (and what change of the ..._ISF_weights
558 would change this. Consult decision flowcharts for effective_ISF in pages 1-6 of the
559 Quick Guide.pdf in <https://github.com/ga-zelle/autolSF>).

560 Depending on the shape of the bg curve after the initial strong rise, and depending on
561 insulinReq. and on iob (> iobTH?), autoISF can provide more SMBs to bring bg to target. This
562 case applies to **low carb** meals. The dura_ISF is also useful to manage temporary insulin
563 resistance often observed late in **fatty** meals.

564

565 **It is worth investing effort** (following the sequence of steps in sections 01-04 of this FCL e-book)
566 **in your initial project to establish a good set of ISF_weights** for your meal spectrum. This will
567 keep interventions in daily life to a minimum.

568 Unless your lifestyle, or health and body weight change radically, this should be **a one-time effort**
569 (in your initial weeks establishing your FCL), with *no need* to fine-tune much later (see [section 8](#)).

570

571 4.2.8 Note regarding acceleration “happening again” in late part of [dropping](#) glucose

572 (*Skip, unless interested*)

573 After the peak, in the late stage of *falling* bg, the glucose curve is like an accelerating
574 parabola again. The algorithm tries to evaluate when and at which bg level complete
575 digestion of the meal and a bg minimum will result. Insulin required to stabilize around
576 target bg is usually very small, and the adaptation of ISF in that stage relatively
577 unimportant. See in your AUTO ISF tab, how, at “already falling” bg, the ISF modulation is
578 taken back.

In version 2.2.8.2 there was a potential deficiency in situations where glucose was falling and the glucose acceleration was already positive. That meant a minimum glucose level can be extrapolated. If that happens to be less than target and expected in less than 15 minutes then there should be no strengthening of ISF as it would lower glucose even more. Therefore bgBrake_ISF_weight is used now instead of bgAccel_ISF_weight. But those situations were rare and less critical than might be expected at first sight. The reason is that in most cases the predictions ended up even below their threshold meaning SMB were disabled.

579

580

581

582 4.3 Managing strong bg rises: pp_ISF

583

584 4.3.1 Main function of pp_ISF in autoISF FCL

585

586 In the later phase of acceleration and in the earlier phase of deceleration there is a more or less
587 linear increase of bg with **high deltas**, and corresponding extra insulin need.

588 • With **higher carb load** meals, or meals that come with a sweet drink, the increase will be
589 particularly strong, and (if not already driven there by bgAccel_ISF) now reach, and with the
590 last “allowed” SMB exceed, the valid iobTH.

591 • With **low carb** meals, there is only a very un-pronounced (short, with weak deltas) “pp_ISF
592 phase”. (Example see end of [case study 4.2](#)).

593

594 autoISF should now “fight” this with the help of the post-prandial ISF, set via **pp_ISF_weight**, after
595 you have set your bgAccel_ISF_weight.

596

597 4.3.2 Tuning pp_ISF_weight

598

599 To tune-in your **pp_ISF_weight**, please do this with a really high carb meal (from within your
600 typical meal spectrum) *after* you have set a halfway suitable (not too aggressive)
601 bgAccel_ISF_weight.

602 Note that if you rush into pp_ISF tuning while “still having a too aggressive bgAccel_ISF”,
603 the latter is covering up the requirement you now really want to calibrate for in pp_ISF!

604

605 So, at a meal in the upper spectrum of your carb load, carefully begin with a starting value for
606 *pp_ISF_weight* of 0.005. Observe the reactions and check the SMB-tab before you increase it
607 cautiously for the next days.

608 Best practice is to analyze the emulator tables (discussed in [section 10](#), and example given
609 in the pizza [case study 4.1](#))

610

611 **How changing the `_weight` influences the resulting calculated `insulinRequired`**

612 (If you “hate math” and rather go in cautious “trial and error steps” for your tuning, you can skip this section
613 and continue 3 pages down at 4.3.3).

614

615 The developers' documentation (Quick Guide, page 5) <https://github.com/ga->

616 [zelle/autoISF/blob/A3.2.0.4_ai3.0.1/autoISF3.0.1_Quick_Guide.pdf](https://github.com/ga-zelle/autoISF/blob/A3.2.0.4_ai3.0.1/autoISF3.0.1_Quick_Guide.pdf) gives the following equation:

$$\text{pp_ISF} = 1 + \text{delta} * \text{pp_ISF_weight.} \quad (\text{eq. 2})$$

617

618 `profile_ISF / pp_ISF = effectively used ISF (sens)`

619

(...if the pp influence dominates, and is used as effective ISF. Else, see flowcharts in Quick Guide)

620

The second equation makes “everything in autoISF” anchor on your `profile_ISF` for the respective hour. This has many implications (see also [section 5](#)). Here we just like to re-emphasize the importance to start your autoISF implementation with a proper `profile_ISF` (that, hopefully, you had determined correctly).

623

1) A proper `profile_ISF` is really necessary.

624

2) If you e.g. used `dynamicISF` to boost ISF when needed, you might in the past have “learned to live” with a too weak `profile_ISF`. This could now introduce the need for stronger `pp_weights` and result in a more “nervous” acting, potentially dangerous (or shut-off) autoISF loop.

625

626

627

3) If you are coming with a too strong `profile_ISF` (a roller-coastering HCL) you now would counter-balance with tuning-in a weaker `pp_weight`, with the result of a less dynamically (but overall still probably OK) acting autoISF loop.

628

629

630 **Note** that the `pp_ISF` effect only comes in when there is positive `short_avg_delta`, AND `bg` is
631 minimum 10 mg/dl **above `bg_target`** already.

632

- Before, we need `bgAccel_ISF` do its job!

633

- Evidently, by setting a lowTT around meal start, you can influence (not the size, but) *how soon `pp_ISF` will “compete with” your `bgAccel_ISF`* (... and this can play out very differently, at different kinds of meal, too.)

634

635

636

637 Tuning: When looking at the same moment (same delta), the effect from using *another* `ISF_weight`,
638 can be mathematically be solved with two (eq.2):

639

640 **Example:** Your `profile_ISF` is 40 mg/dl/U. Using `pp_ISF_weight` of 0.02 you saw effectively
641 used ISF of **30.3** mg/dl/U (box C13 in table below) = $40 / 1.32$ =>

642

factor for `pp_ISF` = 1.32.

643

For an intended correction by – 10 mg/dl the `insulinRequired` would calculate to $10 / 30.3 =$
644 0.330 U.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
1	profile.ISF (mg/dl/U)	40		pp_ISF tuning -				
2	InsReq (U) @delta=0	1		see FCL e-Book section 4.3.2				
3	pp_ISF_weight:	0,02			0,03			InsReq effect
4	delta (mg/dl)	pp_ISF_old	ISF_old	InsReq_old	pp_ISF_new	ISF_new	InsReq_new	(E3 vs.B3)
5	0	1	40	1	1	40	1	0%
6	2	1,04	38,5	1,04	1,06	37,7	1,06	2%
7	4	1,08	37,0	1,08	1,12	35,7	1,12	4%
8	6	1,12	35,7	1,12	1,18	33,9	1,18	5%
9	8	1,16	34,5	1,16	1,24	32,3	1,24	7%
10	10	1,2	33,3	1,2	1,3	30,8	1,3	8%
11	12	1,24	32,3	1,24	1,36	29,4	1,36	10%
12	14	1,28	31,3	1,28	1,42	28,2	1,42	11%
13	16	1,32	30,3	1,32	1,48	27,0	1,48	12%
14	18	1,36	29,4	1,36	1,54	26,0	1,54	13%
15	20	1,4	28,6	1,4	1,6	25,0	1,6	14%
16	22	1,44	27,8	1,44	1,66	24,1	1,66	15%
17	24	1,48	27,0	1,48	1,72	23,3	1,72	16%
18	26	1,52	26,3	1,52	1,78	22,5	1,78	17%
19	28	1,56	25,6	1,56	1,84	21,7	1,84	18%
20	30	1,6	25,0	1,6	1,9	21,1	1,9	19%
21	Note: To determine not the incremental effect between two weights (E3 vs.B3), but the pp_ISF effect							
22	for the investigated _weight (E3): Enter 0 in (B3)							
23	Column (H) then shows the full effect of ppISF with the selected weight (E3)							

Now, going with a 50% stronger pp_ISF_weight of 0.03 (table: E3):

$$\text{pp_ISF} = 1 + \text{delta} * \text{pp_ISF_weight}$$

before $1,32 = 1 + 0,02 * \text{delta} \Rightarrow 0,32 = 0,02 * \text{delta} \Rightarrow \text{delta} = 16 \text{ mg/dl}$

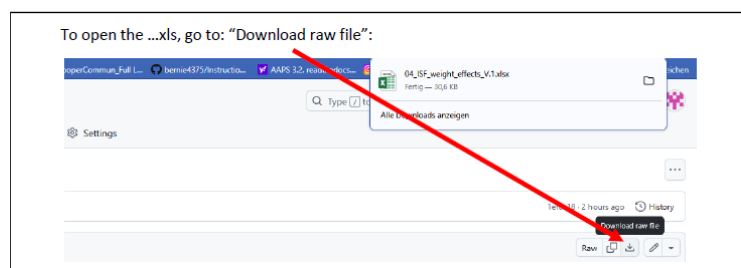
after $? = 1 + 0,03 * \text{delta} \Rightarrow ? = 1 + 0,03 * 16 = 1,48$

New effective ISF would be $40 / 1,48 = 27,03 \text{ mg/dl/U}$ (box F13 in table).

For an intended correction by – 10 mg/dl the insulinRequired would now calculate to $10 / 27,03 = 0,370 \text{ U}$, which is 12.1 % more insulin (box H13 in table).

The % effect would be more or also less pronounced, depending how strong bg is rising (delta), which is of course the key idea behind pp_ISF.

An Excel tool is provided in e-book section 04 (Github/bernie4375) for this calculation. However, a simple “trial and error” approach as outlined initially in this 4.3.2 section (2 pages before) might be easier to handle.



To summarize, tuning-in the pp_ISF_weight allows the user to define her/his personal sweet spot for ISF aggressiveness in the phase of strongly rising bg.

- As different kinds of meals will have different delta patterns, it can well be that one pp_ISF_weight (as set by you in AAPS preferences) is good for all meals.

- Note that a circadian profileISF provides an avenue to still differentiate between e.g. breakfast and lunch response of your autoISF loop.

4.3.3 Loop states with very little insulin need ($iob > iob_{TH}$, or 0 %TBR)

Normally (except for very low carb meals) the SMBs triggered by `bgAccel_ISF_weight` and `pp_ISF_weight` should be sufficient to reach and slightly exceed the **`iobTH`** (see [section 2.4](#)) so all *the other* autoISF parameters are relatively unimportant for now.

A reason why this can work at all, also for quite a variety of meals, lies in the fact that there is an hourly carb absorption limit of about 30g/h

(Reference: Dana

Lewis: <https://github.com/danamlewis/artificialpancreasbook/blob/master/8.-tips-and-tricks-for-real-life-with-an-aps.md#heres-the-detailed-explanation-of-what-we-learned>. (That limit

can be lower, e.g. with gastroparesis or certain medications, but that would make things even easier)

So while meals might wildly vary in composition and size: What is digested, and needs insulin in the first ~90 minutes (when FCL tries to catch up with insulin need and differs strongly from HCL, with `bgAccel_ISF` and `pp_ISF` in the leading role), will be relatively close...for meals with similar *initial* glucose acceleration and rises, anyways...

The others, **low carb** with much slower initial acceleration and rise, are easily recognized as different by the loop, see [section 4.4](#) that follows.

Depending on the type of meal and "aggressiveness" of your `bgAccel_ISF_weight` and `pp_ISF_weight` tuning, the `iob` will already be so high that, in the phase of decelerated glucose rise towards the peak (the "last part of the rise"), no more `insulinRequired` is seen by the loop.

Therefore the **`bgBrake_ISF_weight`** is often unimportant in meals with a relevant carb content.

For potential relevance in low carb meals, see [section 4.4](#).

4.3.4 "Quality control" on how well your tuning can replace your former HCL bolussing

Warning: **Occasionally consult the AUTO ISF tab to see how your settings really work.**

A setting (...ISF_weight) that is actually set too aggressive might be masked.

Tuning only works if the effects of the settings being tuned are **not** unintentionally **limited by other** (e.g., "safety") **settings**.

707 Also, **always look at two or three *different* meals** before deciding whether a tuning "fits" („good
708 enough“ for each of them). You probably will have to iterate back and forth doing this for two or
709 three different kinds of meals ...

- 710 • [Case Study 4.1](#) (Pizza Meal) contains, towards the end, an example how you can go about
711 tuning the `_weights` for various `_ISF` factors of `autoISF`.
- 712 • [Case Study 8.2](#) shows that it is **not** worth it to seek “optimized” settings based on just one
713 (more extreme) meal.

714 ... until you find *one* good enough set of settings *for all* of them. Do not rush this, establishing a
715 solid foundation will be well worth your time.

716
717 **The following sections will deal with similar issues like you were facing in HCL after your**
718 **given bolus lost much of its power, and SMBs were needed for the “eCarbs”.**

719 720 4.4 Sluggish rise towards a bg peak: `bgBrake_ISF`

721
722 At a **low carb** meal, or an attempt at doing a **weight reduction diet**,
723 (and probably also with gastroparesis, or if you take one of these novel GLP-1 drugs that slow meal absorption;
724 see [section 13.7](#); *somebody, please supply a case study!*)-

725 the glucose goes up only sluggishly, and `iobTH` should not be reached at all. See also [case study](#)
726 [4.2](#)

727 In case you *exclusively* do very slow absorbing meals, you could of course also adjust your `iobTH`
728 setting low enough to suit your *uniform* situation.

729
730 Acceleration, and the phase of strong glucose rise, are quickly over at slow-absorbing meals, and
731 there can be:

- 732 • a decelerating bulge of insulin action that projects over an hour or longer. This is where the
733 importance of the **`bgBrake_ISF`** can come in.
- 734 • a bg curve that hovers for an hour or longer around an elevated bg level, because
735 additionally absorbed carbs, and consumption of the moderate SMBs delivered, tend to
736 keep a balance for a while. **`dura_ISF`** can deal with this (see next chapter). An example for
737 this is given in [Case study 4.2](#).

738 Note that in some data outputs (e.g. the csv/xls tables coming from the Emulator, e.g. in Case study 4.2,
739 big table at the end there), you will see only “**`acce_ISF`**” results.

- 740 • In case of positive acceleration, these are driven by the `bgAccel_ISF_weight` setting, and results
741 are >1 .
- 742 • In case of negative acceleration (decelerating rise), **`bgBrake_ISF_weight` is applied**, , and
743 results are <1 :

- 744 ○ (eq.1) from section 4.2.4 still applies, now in the form of
745 $acce_ISF = 1 + bgBrake_ISF_weight * internalFactor$, with the internal factor
746 becoming negative at negative acceleration. Therefore $acceISF < 1$ results at
747 braking (see e.g. in graph in [section 10.3.3.3](#)).
- 748 ○ The $newISF = oldISF / acce_ISF$ is the bigger (softer acting), the higher your
749 selected $bgBrake_ISF_weight$ makes the term that is subtracted from 1

750

751 In Full Closed Loop, the $bgBrake_ISF_weight$ is often only about half as large as the
752 $bgAccel_ISF_weight$:

- 753 • In the $acce$ phase, we need quite high $bgAccel_ISF_weight$ for fast ramping up of iob.
754 But afterwards, when approaching bg peak, there usually is little insulin required. Or, if (in
755 low carb meals) there is, it may not be smart to soften the $profile_ISF$ in the brake stage by
756 much.
- 757 • So, the role of $brake_ISF$ (and settings for it) would depend on your personal diet pattern
758 and eating/digestion speed also.
- 759 • Note that your $autoISF_min$ setting could limit how much “softer” you maximally can go.
760 However, suggestion in [section 2.2](#) was to set it to 0.3, so that should be OK to start any
761 tuning with.

762

763 Approach the tuning gradually, at situations (meals) where the $brake_ISF$ actually has a role,
764 increasing the weight coming from small values.

765

766 Please observe that **tuning $bgBrake_ISF_weight$ must strictly be done with types of meals for**
767 **which there is insulin need at de-celerating but still rising bg .**

- 768 • $bgBrake_ISF$ is totally irrelevant for hi carb meals where your loop shot over $iobTH$ already
769 by the time your rising towards the bg peak slows down!

770 Likewise, if your initial $bgAccel_weight$ is set so strong that your first SMBs catapult you
771 over the $iobTH$, no matter what type of meal: Then you must **first** find a reasonable setting
772 for this parameter, one that works “good enough” to control your carb loaded meals, and
773 then see whether there is “room” (and need) for milder loop response at low carb meals.

- 774 • **Do not worry if you can’t really find scenarios where the $brake_ISF$ plays a**
775 **significant role. Then:**

- 776 ○ set the recommended start setting (half of your $acce_weight$ for brake)
- 777 ○ **move on to $dura_ISF$ tuning**

778 ○ Analyze your data while dura tuning for an eventual role of brake, and an eventual
779 fine tuning opportunity

780

781 **Intermediate summary on acce, pp, brake phase, where the goal was that the FCL must**
782 **quickly replace “our missing bolus”**

783

784 During your tuning, you should have tested meals that strongly vary in composition and size (as in
785 your daily life).

786

787 First effort was to shoot iob over iobTH quickly for meals with substantial fast carb components.

788

789 There is a chance that you could not quite get all the ISF_weights “right”, so the occasional low
790 carb meal will not get over-treated:

791

792 You could try harder in your initial tuning. Or just take note where the limits lie for your basic tuning
793 at this stage. Avenues to adapt your loop aggressiveness when required are discussed in
794 [section 5](#).

795

796 For instance you will be able to (if needed):

797

- 798 • use a temp. reduced %profile
- 799 • temp. lower iobTH or bgAccel_ISF_weight
- 800 • construct for yourself a “DIY cockpit” with an extra “snack” or “low carb” button with an
801 underlying suitable Automation

802

803 **Moving on, towards the late meal phase: “UAM FCL challenge”**

804

805 In the **late stage of still rising (!) glucose**, the Full Closed Loop typically sharply reduces
806 SMBs already because it is “painfully aware” of the following upcoming principal conflict:

807

- 808 • iob (like formerly given in HCL via your bolus) must go high quickly, in order to limit the high
- 809 • However, if there is too much insulin in the system, a **hypoglycemia can happen later**
810 within the DIA time window(s), because the loop can, later, only correct to a very limited
811 extent (namely, only to the extent that it can set basal to zero).

812 Therefore, the core problem is that the Full Closed Loop must build up iob very quickly, **but**
813 **not too much**, in the initial phase of a meal, and high bg values (out of range, >180 mg/dl)
814 cannot be avoided always.

815 Limiting iob is especially challenging in an exercise context. For this we provide the
816 exercise mode with a “dynamic_iobTH”, see in [section 6](#).

817

818 Also, in UAM mode, with no inputs for carbs or FPU, the loop must operate with recent
819 and predicted carb deviations,

- 820 • which, you could say, adds another level of uncertainty;
- 821 • however, I would argue that user inputs on amounts and absorption times of carbs
822 and FPU would very often give the loop data that are worse than what it can
823 calculate, and every 5 minutes adjust (to reality what actually was digested, and to
824 consumed insulin, in the last 5 minute segment);
- 825 • see [section 4.5.9](#) and references there for more on how the oref loop works.

826

4.5 Sluggish rise into a bg plateau, or late plateauing at high bg: dura_ISF and bg_ISF

Depending how your personal diet spectrum looks, you need to tune-in your dura_ISF primarily with large hi-FPU meals, and/or for meals at the low carb end of your diet

4.5.1 dura_ISF for sluggish rise into a bg plateau

A (in that case, often not very high) plateau can form in **low carb meals**, when, basically, carb and insulin “burn rates” might keep a balance over an hour or longer, requiring occasional moderate size SMBs.(See an example in [case study 4.2](#))

4.5.2 dura_ISF for late/high bg plateaus

With **large or high fat/protein meals**, often a long high bg plateau is encountered (sometimes associated with 2nd “late, long stretched hill” forming for this, in the bg curve). For such situations, autoISF features the modulation of ISF depending on bg level and on duration of **plateau** formation.

4.5.3 “One size fits all” -dura_ISF

Absolute “pros” could primarily calibrate their dura_ISF for low carb.

Dura_ISF has in-built amplification at higher bg levels. So, effects will automatically be boosted in case much higher plateaus develop after greasy feasts.

Should that not per se be sufficient, there is more the DIY “pro” can do:

- by adding an Automation that gives an extra boost “against” the temporary insulin resistance associated with fats (via increasing the baseline, in terms of a temp.130% profile switch, for instance. Compare at: <https://androidaps.readthedocs.io/en/latest/Usage/FullClosedLoop.html#stagnation-at-high-bg-values>),
- or by making additional use of the bg_ISF (or dynamicISF) (-> Tune it in parallel.)

The author’s preference would be to go via Automation, but only in case the in-built differentiation via bg level make it necessary.

865 4.5.4 Options to limit iob delivered from dura_ISF

866

867 Rather than relying on your initial tuning **to keep you safe from hypos** also in the future, there are
868 some extra precautions you could take. Some were discussed in Discord [or in dev circles](#),
869 regarding what could be done:

870

871 1) To limit the danger of going low, it can make sense to
872 design an **Automation** which pauses the delivery of more
873 insulin.

874

875 This one was suggested by Alex999

876

877 If a glucose plateau built under 140 mg/dl, do not treat via
878 dura_ISF (because the defined Action is to set an elevated
879 TT to a level that will not require more correction insulin).

880

881 An alternative Action would be to set, near the actual
882 glucose target, an odd-numbered TT (which blocks any
883 SMB be given, while valid).

884

885 2) Via another **Automation**, you could make use of the modulation of dura_ISF by bg target.

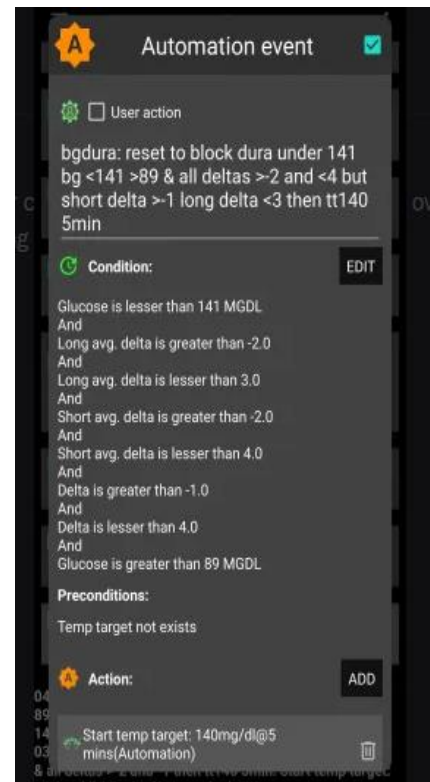
886 To prepare this, go in FCL e-book to @ [dura](#) subsheet of [04_ISF_weights_effects...xls](#) :

887 Input two different target bg in J1 and in J21, and decide *when* (easy to set low TT for the
888 duration you want the setting more aggressive), *or at which conditions* (that you put into your
889 Automation) you want to jump into the "softer" (higher) ISF curve.

890 That way you can program, suitable for your typical data, a dura_ISF with decreasing
891 aggressiveness at longer duration. (Your tuning of the dura_ISF_weight would have to be done
892 with this modality implemented. It will result in a milder dura_ISF and hence lower hypo risk,
893 while fat-related insulin resistance is treated stronger, initially as signs arise).

894 3) The proposal developed in 2) counter-acts really the dura_ISF design which strengthens
895 dura_ISF with duration. [In an autoISF update, the duration in which iob is added up could be](#)
896 [capped after max. 1.5 hours of any "stubborn high", with a similar result \(but by far less](#)
897 [flexible- than 2\).](#)

898 4) [Instead of 3\), or additionally, the total iob accrued in that "dura phase" could be capped by](#)
899 [a new related safety setting. It would probably be anchored on iobTH, and could also become a](#)
900 [tuneable setting, maybe even a new parameter useable in Automations, too.](#)



901 4.5.5 How dura_ISF works

902

903 Conditions for dura_ISF to become active:

- 904 1) Glucose plateaus, i.e. it is varying within a +/- 5% interval only, and this situation lasted at
905 least for the last 10 minutes => Duration **dura_05** = 10 or more minutes.
- 906 2) The average glucose value in this “duration” time window is **avg05** mg/dl. Its elevation rela-
907 tive to bg target determines one of the factors in the equation (eq.3) for dura_ISF, see be-
908 low.

909 Effect:

- 910 • The strengthening of ISF is stronger **the longer** the situation lasts, and **the higher** the av-
911 erage glucose is above target:
- 912 3) This can be individually tuned by the **duraISF_weight** to automatically manage high plat-
913 eaus in bg values.

914

915 How changing the _weight influences the resulting calculated insulinRequired

916 (If you “hate math” and rather go in cautious “trial and error steps” for your tuning, you can skip this section
917 and continue at 4.5.6.

918 Still it might be worth your time to at least “play around” a bit in the

919 ○ dura subsheet of 04_ISF_weights_effects...xls

920 to see (in colored charts) how your SMBs strengthen depending on duration and height of a bg plateau, your
921 target_bg, with a dura_ISF_weight you could set. Example given below, at line 979-997).

922

923 The developers’ documentation (Quick Guide, page 6) <https://github.com/ga->

924 [zelle/autolSF/blob/A3.2.0.4_ai3.0.1/autolSF3.0.1_Quick_Guide.pdf](https://github.com/ga-zelle/autolSF/blob/A3.2.0.4_ai3.0.1/autolSF3.0.1_Quick_Guide.pdf) gives the following equation:

925

$$\text{dura_ISF} = 1 + \frac{\text{avg05} - \text{target_bg}}{\text{target_bg}} * \frac{\text{dura05}}{60} * \text{dura_ISF_weight} \quad (\text{eq. 3})$$

926

$$\text{profile_ISF} / \text{dura_ISF} = \text{effectively used ISF (sens)}$$

928 (...if the dura influence dominates, and is used as effective ISF. Else, see flowcharts in Quick Guide)

929

930 When looking at the same moment, we can combine the first two factors of eq.3 (which vary with bg
931 elevation above bg target, and with how long the plateau already shows) into a term “**iF**”.

932

933 For estimating the effect from using *another* ISF_weight, we then have *two* (eq.3) , with two unknowns, **iF**
934 (“cancelling out”), and the sought dura_ISF (that results for the new _weight).

935

936 **Example:** Your profile_ISF is 40 mg/dl/U.

937 Using dura_ISF_weight of 0.6 you saw effectively used ISF of **30.3** mg/dl/U (box C21 in
938 table on next page) = 40 / 1.32 => dura_ISF =1.32 (see eq.3), and eq. below it)

For an intended correction by – 10 mg/dl the insulinRequired would calculate to $10 / 30.3 = 0.330$ U.

Now, going with a **33% stronger** dura_ISF_weight of 0.80 (box E3):

$$\text{dura_ISF} = 1 + \text{internalFactor} * \text{dura_ISF_weight} *$$

before $1.32 = 1 + 0.60 * \text{iF} \Rightarrow 0.32 = 0.60 * \text{iF} \Rightarrow \text{iF} = 0.533$

after $? = 1 + 0.80 * \text{iF} \Rightarrow ? = 1 + 0.80 * 0.533 = 1.426$

New effective ISF would be $40 / 1.426 = 28.04$ mg/dl/U (F21 in table).

For an intended correction by – 10 mg/dl the insulinRequired would now calculate to $10 / 28.04 = 0.357$ U, which is **8.1 % more** insulin (H21 in table next page).

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
1	profile.ISF (mg/dl/U)	40		dura_ISF tuning -				
2	InsReq (U) @ iF=0	1		see FCL e-Book section 4.5.5				
3	dura_ISF_weight	0.6		0.8				
4	iF	dura_ISF_old	ISF_old	InsReq_old	dura_ISF_new	ISF_new	InsReq_new	E3 vs B3
5	0	1	40	1	1	40	1	0.0%
6	0.033	1,020	39.2	1,020	1,027	39.0	1,027	0.7%
7	0.067	1,040	38.5	1,040	1,053	38.0	1,053	1.3%
8	0.100	1,060	37.7	1,060	1,080	37.0	1,080	1.9%
9	0.133	1,080	37.0	1,080	1,107	36.1	1,107	2.5%
10	0.167	1,100	36.4	1,100	1,133	35.3	1,133	3.0%
11	0.200	1,120	35.7	1,120	1,160	34.5	1,160	3.6%
12	0.233	1,140	35.1	1,140	1,187	33.7	1,187	4.1%
13	0.266	1,160	34.5	1,160	1,213	33.0	1,213	4.6%
14	0.300	1,180	33.9	1,180	1,240	32.3	1,240	5.1%
15	0.333	1,200	33.3	1,200	1,266	31.6	1,266	5.6%
16	0.366	1,220	32.8	1,220	1,293	30.9	1,293	6.0%
17	0.400	1,240	32.3	1,240	1,320	30.3	1,320	6.4%
18	0.433	1,260	31.8	1,260	1,346	29.7	1,346	6.9%
19	0.466	1,280	31.3	1,280	1,373	29.1	1,373	7.3%
20	0.500	1,300	30.8	1,300	1,400	28.6	1,400	7.7%
21	0.533	1,320	30.3	1,320	1,426	28.0	1,426	8.1%
22	0.566	1,340	29.9	1,340	1,453	27.5	1,453	8.5%
23	0.599	1,360	29.4	1,360	1,480	27.0	1,480	8.9%
24	0.633	1,380	29.0	1,380	1,506	26.6	1,506	9.2%
25	0.666	1,400	28.6	1,400	1,533	26.1	1,533	9.5%
26	0.699	1,420	28.2	1,420	1,559	25.6	1,559	9.9%
27	0.733	1,440	27.8	1,440	1,586	25.2	1,586	10.2%
28	0.766	1,460	27.4	1,460	1,613	24.8	1,613	10.5%
29	0.799	1,480	27.0	1,480	1,639	24.4	1,639	10.8%
30	0.833	1,500	26.7	1,500	1,666	24.0	1,666	11.1%
31	0.866	1,519	26.3	1,519	1,693	23.6	1,693	11.4%
32	0.899	1,539	26.0	1,539	1,719	23.3	1,719	11.7%
33	0.932	1,559	25.6	1,559	1,746	22.9	1,746	12.0%

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
34	0.966	1,579	25.3	1,579	1,773	22.6	1,773	12.2%
35	0.999	1,599	25.0	1,599	1,799	22.2	1,799	12.5%
36	1.032	1,619	24.7	1,619	1,826	21.9	1,826	12.7%
37	1.066	1,639	24.4	1,639	1,853	21.6	1,853	13.0%
38	1.099	1,659	24.1	1,659	1,879	21.3	1,879	13.2%
39	1.132	1,679	23.8	1,679	1,906	21.0	1,906	13.5%
40	1.166	1,699	23.5	1,699	1,932	20.7	1,932	13.7%
41	1.199	1,719	23.3	1,719	1,959	20.4	1,959	13.9%
42	1.232	1,739	23.0	1,739	1,986	20.1	1,986	14.2%
43	1.265	1,759	22.7	1,759	2,012	19.9	2,012	14.4%
44	1.30	1,780	22.5	1,780	2,040	19.6	2,040	14.6%
45	1.40	1,840	21.7	1,840	2,120	18.9	2,120	15.2%
46	1.50	1,900	21.1	1,900	2,200	18.2	2,200	15.8%
47	1.60	1,960	20.4	1,960	2,280	17.5	2,280	16.3%
48	1.70	2,020	19.8	2,020	2,360	16.9	2,360	16.8%
49	1.80	2,080	19.2	2,080	2,440	16.4	2,440	17.3%
50	1.90	2,140	18.7	2,140	2,520	15.9	2,520	17.8%
51	2.00	2,200	18.2	2,200	2,600	15.4	2,600	18.2%
52	2.10	2,260	17.7	2,260	2,680	14.9	2,680	18.6%
53	2.20	2,320	17.2	2,320	2,760	14.5	2,760	19.0%
54	2.30	2,380	16.8	2,380	2,840	14.1	2,840	19.3%
55	2.40	2,440	16.4	2,440	2,920	13.7	2,920	19.7%
56	2.50	2,500	16.0	2,500	3,000	13.3	3,000	20.0%
57	3.0	2,800	14.3	2,800	3,400	11.8	3,400	21.4%
58	3.5	3,100	12.9	3,100	3,800	10.5	3,800	22.6%
59	4.0	3,400	11.8	3,400	4,200	9.5	4,200	23.5%
60	4.5	3,700	10.8	3,700	4,600	8.7	4,600	24.3%
61	5.0	4,000	10.0	4,000	5,000	8.0	5,000	25.0%
62	Note: To determine not the incremental effect between two weights (E3 vs B3), but the dura_ISF effect							
63	for the investigated _weight (E3): Enter 0 in (B3)							
64	Column (H) then shows the full effect of duraISF with the selected weight (E3)							
65	Use table (I21 x S39 or higher), input target_bg at (J21), then look up iF for the observed dura							
66	and avg05 => which "iF" line" applies in table (A3 x H61)							

The effects could be more or also less pronounced because the **iF factor** strongly depends (as in eq.3, see also table on next page) on:

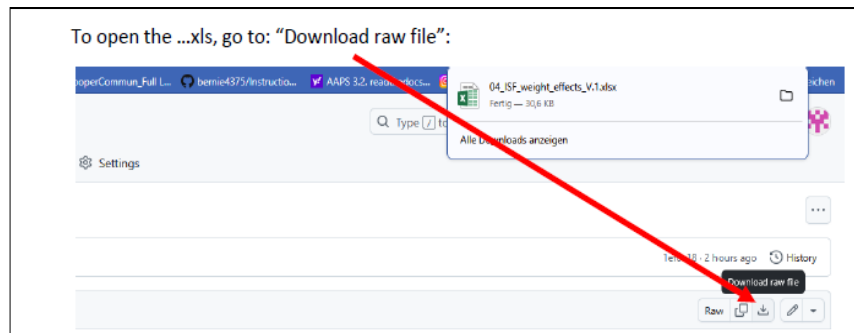
- how high bg is above target (**avg05**)..
- ...and for how many minutes (**dura05**).
- Also, do not under-estimate the effect of a low **target_bg**. Not sure you should, but certainly *you could* add an extra boost from that via an Automation that kicks in a low TT (at the “dura situation” that you describe as a triggering condition in your related Automation):

Example: You plateau at 180 mg/dl and your bg target is 100. The first factor in your iF term then is $(180-100)/100 = 0.80$.

Now, with a TT = 74 mg/dl, that term becomes $(180 - 74)/74 = 1.43$

(The resulting + 79% in your boost factor does not translate into 79% more insulin - just as we have seen “only” 8% more insulin with a 33% boost in the complete example before).

An **Excel tool** is provided to download as raw file ...from the e-book (Github /bernie4375/section 04) for these complex calculations.



- see @ [dura](#) subsheet of [04_ISF_weights_effects...xls](#)

980 The following table (from this tool) shows examples for combinations of **bg target** (yellow input field
 981 at box J1 resp. box J22) , **bg plateau level** (mg/dl, blue figures), and **duration** (minutes >10, in
 982 violet), the **iF** of **0.533** in our example above could originate (fields marked green):

	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S
1	target_bg	100 =>	iF factors resulting at different avg05 (mg/dl.bg), and duration (minutes)								
2	dura05;avg05	120	140	160	180	200	220	240	260	280	300
3	10	0,033	0,067	0,100	0,133	0,167	0,200	0,233	0,267	0,300	0,333
4	15	0,050	0,100	0,150	0,200	0,250	0,300	0,350	0,400	0,450	0,500
5	20	0,067	0,133	0,200	0,267	0,333	0,400	0,467	0,533	0,600	0,667
6	25	0,083	0,167	0,250	0,333	0,417	0,500	0,583	0,667	0,750	0,833
7	30	0,100	0,200	0,300	0,400	0,500	0,600	0,700	0,800	0,900	1,000
8	35	0,117	0,233	0,350	0,467	0,583	0,700	0,817	0,933	1,050	1,167
9	40	0,133	0,267	0,400	0,533	0,667	0,800	0,933	1,067	1,200	1,333
10	45	0,150	0,300	0,450	0,600	0,750	0,900	1,050	1,200	1,350	1,500
11	50	0,167	0,333	0,500	0,667	0,833	1,000	1,167	1,333	1,500	1,667
12	55	0,183	0,367	0,550	0,733	0,917	1,100	1,283	1,467	1,650	1,833
13	60	0,200	0,400	0,600	0,800	1,000	1,200	1,400	1,600	1,800	2,000
14	65	0,217	0,433	0,650	0,867	1,083	1,300	1,517	1,733	1,950	2,167
15	70	0,233	0,467	0,700	0,933	1,167	1,400	1,633	1,867	2,100	2,333
16	75	0,250	0,500	0,750	1,000	1,250	1,500	1,750	2,000	2,250	2,500
17	80	0,267	0,533	0,800	1,067	1,333	1,600	1,867	2,133	2,400	2,667
18	85	0,283	0,567	0,850	1,133	1,417	1,700	1,983	2,267	2,550	2,833
19	90	0,300	0,600	0,900	1,200	1,500	1,800	2,100	2,400	2,700	3,000

983

22	target_bg	74 =>	iF factors resulting at different avg05 (mg/dl.bg), and duration (minutes)								
23	dura05;avg05	120	140	160	180	200	220	240	260	280	300
24	10	0,104	0,149	0,194	0,239	0,284	0,329	0,374	0,419	0,464	0,509
25	15	0,155	0,223	0,291	0,358	0,426	0,493	0,561	0,628	0,696	0,764
26	20	0,207	0,297	0,387	0,477	0,568	0,658	0,748	0,838	0,928	1,018
27	25	0,259	0,372	0,484	0,597	0,709	0,822	0,935	1,047	1,160	1,273
28	30	0,311	0,446	0,581	0,716	0,851	0,986	1,122	1,257	1,392	1,527
29	35	0,363	0,520	0,678	0,836	0,993	1,151	1,309	1,466	1,624	1,782
30	40	0,414	0,595	0,775	0,955	1,135	1,315	1,495	1,676	1,856	2,036
31	45	0,466	0,669	0,872	1,074	1,277	1,480	1,682	1,885	2,088	2,291
32	50	0,518	0,743	0,968	1,194	1,419	1,644	1,869	2,095	2,320	2,545
33	55	0,570	0,818	1,065	1,313	1,561	1,809	2,056	2,304	2,552	2,800
34	60	0,622	0,892	1,162	1,432	1,703	1,973	2,243	2,514	2,784	3,054
35	65	0,673	0,966	1,259	1,552	1,845	2,137	2,430	2,723	3,016	3,309
36	70	0,725	1,041	1,356	1,671	1,986	2,302	2,617	2,932	3,248	3,563
37	75	0,777	1,115	1,453	1,791	2,128	2,466	2,804	3,142	3,480	3,818
38	80	0,829	1,189	1,550	1,910	2,270	2,631	2,991	3,351	3,712	4,072
39	85	0,881	1,264	1,646	2,029	2,412	2,795	3,178	3,561	3,944	4,327
39	90	0,932	1,338	1,743	2,149	2,554	2,959	3,365	3,770	4,176	4,581

984

985

986 To see the effect you can expect from employing
 987 dura_ISF (with your selected weight of 0,8 in the
 988 following example, say to help when stuck for 60
 989 minutes at 220 (iF = 2 if you set a 74TT) :

990 This would lower e.g. your ISF from 40 (blue) to
 991 15 (orange, nearly 3 times more aggressive).
 992 And your insulinRequ. would be boosted by a
 993 factor of 2.7 (1 green -> 2.7 yellow, right side y axis)

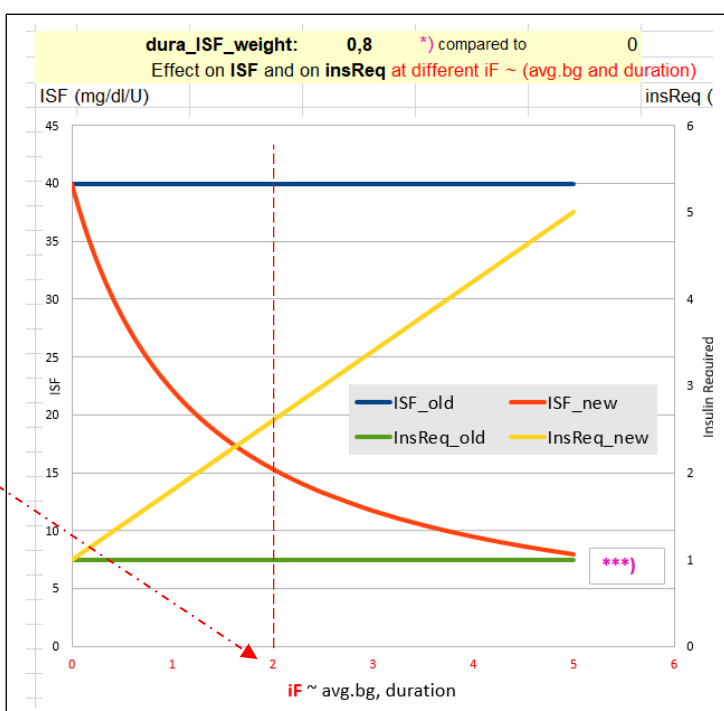
994

995

996

997

998



999 Still. a “trial and error” approach might be easier to handle (see the following [section, 4.5.6](#)):

1000 *Off topic:* dura_ISF is also very useful in Hybrid Closed Loop. It can be used to elegantly manage,
1001 fully automatically, a temporary insulin resistance from fatty acids. Please refer to other papers for
1002 details (for instance, sections on FPU and persistent high bg in “Meal Mgt.3....pdf”, available here:
1003 <https://github.com/bernie4375/HCL-Meal-Mgt.-ISF-and-IC-settings>).

1004

1005 4.5.6 Set your dura_ISF

1006

1007 Set a **start value of 0.2** for your dura_ISF_weight, and increase only cautiously with an eye on
1008 hypo prevention 2-3 hours later.

1009

1010 As demonstrated in the preceding “math section”, a set **low TT** can strongly influence the workings
1011 of dura_ISF. You can explore an eventual advantage from combining an Automation that sets a TT
1012 at certain bg curve characteristics. To limit hypo danger, it is probably a good idea to have the TT
1013 only for very few SMBs, and no longer active towards the end of the plateau (see also [4.5.4](#))

1014

1015 Caution: Fine tuning your dura_ISF_weight only makes sense **after** you tuned your bgAccel_ISF
1016 and pp_ISF well (so your thin yellow insulin activity curve shifts *as far to the left*, towards meal
1017 start, *as possible*, which will lower bg peaks, shorten plateau duration, and hence will ease the job
1018 for dura_ISF).

1019

1020 4.5.7 Set your bg_ISF

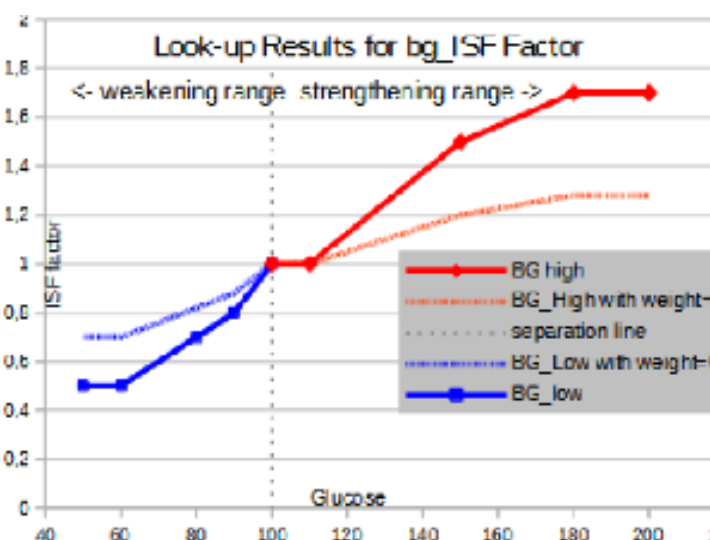
1021

1022 [Concept of bg_ISF in autoISF](#) (from Quick guide @ github/ga-zelle)

1023

1024 There is some evidence that at higher bg levels, stronger (lower) ISFs may be useful, and many
1025 AAPS users use self-constructed Automations to do that. The concept of bg_ISF is to integrate this
1026 in a gradual and tuneable manner:

1027 In autoISF a polygon is provided that defines a relationship between glucose and ISF and interpolates in between. This is currently hard coded but the user can apply weights to easily strengthen or weaken it in order to fit personal needs. In principle the polygon itself can be edited and the apk rebuilt if a different shape is required. Developing a GUI for that purpose was considered very tedious especially before knowing whether the results warrant the effort. With this approach you could even approximate the formula well enough that is used in DynamicISF for the ISF dependency on glucose.



There are two weighting factors depending on whether glucose is below or above target:

lower_ISFrange_weight Used below target, weakens ISF the more the higher this weight is; 0 disables this contribution, i.e. ISF is constant in the whole range below target.

This weight is less critical as the loop is probably running at TBR=0 anyway and you can start around 0.2.

higher_ISFrange_weight Used above target, strengthens ISF the more the higher this weight is 0 disables this contribution, i.e. ISF is constant in the whole range above target.

Start with a weight of 0.2 and observe the reactions and check the SMB-tab before you increase it with care.

The result is:

$$\text{bg_ISF} = 1 + \text{xxx_ISFrange_weight} * \text{glucose_polygon_Lookup} \quad (\text{eq.4})$$

xxx: *higher or lower*

glucose_polygon_Lookup: see graph above

profile_ISF / bg_ISF = effectively used ISF (sens)

if bg effect dominates

Tool to decide on (for your data) best method for bg-dependent ISF

The “bg, dyn” subsheet of [04_ISF_weights_effects...xls](#) in FCL e-book

- allows to tune your bg_ISF,
- or (notably in HCL) helps find which of the methods, at which settings (in dynamic or in autoISF) might suit your needs best.

Limited usefulness in FCL, and recommended settings

Since in Full Closed Loop we make our loop give us the maximum SMB size it can, at the beginning of a rise, it is crucial to **resist the temptation to continue** with a particularly **strong ISF** in the meal phase with the **highest glucose** values .

This is a reason why in Full Closed Loop we do not make much use of the **bg_ISF** component of autoISF.

- Wanting to get most of our insulin from SMBs delivered at fairly low (but beginning-to-rise) bg implies that we do **not** make ISF weaker at low bg. Under preferences/OpenAPS SMB/autoISF/bg_ISF settings you could set **lower ISF_range_weight** = 0.0.

If you want to analyze in your data, whether you might benefit from a milder ISF at low bg values (e.g. if you often go below target after correction of only mildly elevated bg in the preceding hours), you may want to try lower ISF_range_weight = 0.1 or 0.2. Study the

1059 effects from bgISF, and increase, or decrease, the bgISF_weight to fine tune the sought-
1060 after affect.

- 1061 • The **higher_ISF_range_weight** is used when bg is above target, It then strengthens ISF
1062 the more the higher the set weight is. 0 disables this contribution, i.e. ISF is constant in the
1063 whole range above target.

1064 In FCL, this factor should be fairly irrelevant: Near glucose peak, zero-tempering usually
1065 prevails anyway, so the settings we try might often not be used really by the loop. Very
1066 likely, you can live with setting the weight to = 0.0 here, too.

1067 If you want to analyze in your data, whether you might benefit from a stronger ISF at high
1068 bg values (e.g. if you often remain above target after correction of elevated bg in the
1069 preceding hours), you may want to try higher ISF_range_weight = 0.1 or 0.2. Study the
1070 effects from bg_ISF, and increase, or decrease, the higher_ISF_range_weight to fine tune
1071 the sought-after affect.

1072 In case bg_ISF shall play a bigger role in your loop, please consult the related developers'
1073 documentation (Quick Guide, page 4) at: [https://github.com/ga-](https://github.com/ga-zelle/autolSF/blob/A3.2.0.4_ai3.0.1/autolSF3.0.1_Quick_Guide.pdf)
1074 [zelle/autolSF/blob/A3.2.0.4_ai3.0.1/autolSF3.0.1_Quick_Guide.pdf](https://github.com/ga-zelle/autolSF/blob/A3.2.0.4_ai3.0.1/autolSF3.0.1_Quick_Guide.pdf) .

1075

1076 4.5.8 “Quality control” on your tuning for the later half of your meal time

1077

1078 The later stages of meal management (both, in HCL and in FCL) struggle with the problem that
1079 there is a **hypo danger** from the “tail” of insulin activity from earlier SMBs that were needed to
1080 fight high bg or plateaus associated with temporary insulin resistance.

1081

1082 Once your bg sits high, neither you, nor a hybrid closed loop with all the carb info, nor your FCL
1083 can work wonders.

1084

1085 Very important:

- 1086 • Iterate between **2 or 3 kinds of meals** (from your typical spectrum) to find **one** set of
1087 settings that works *good-enough for all*. That should be possible.
- 1088 • If you can't make it work for certain meal types, see [sections 4.7](#) and [5](#). what you can do
1089 then.

1090 Observe hypo trends after meals, and

- 1091 • resist the temptation to elevate the **dura_ISF_weight** very high.
- 1092 • try to stay away from **bg_ISF** or dynamicISF in Full Closed Loop:

- 1093 ○ In FCL you probably can afford to shut bg_ISF entirely off via setting both related
1094 _ weights to 0.0.
- 1095 ○ At least be careful, use small ISF_range_weights and check whether you are happy
1096 with the contributions to the effectively used ISFs
- 1097 ○ *Off topic:* If, coming from dynamicISF usage, you stay in **Hybrid** Closed Loop, but now with
1098 autoISF, you probably can use the bg_ISF parameter with higher _weights to emulate what
1099 you like to replicate from your dynamicISF experience.

1100

1101 bg highs will take time to resolve.

1102 Interestingly, an after-dinner walk can work wonders sometimes (take glucose tablets along).

1103

1104 Zero-tempering and too tightly set safety limits can be **stumbling blocks in your tuning** project:

- 1105 • Investigating effects of set ISF_weights is not really possible in periods of zero-tempering.
- 1106 • Too tightly set safety limits “allow” tuning that really is way too aggressive, but gets “cut” by
1107 your too-cautious safety settings (e.g. for SMB_range_extention, or for autoISFmax).
1108 Aggressive settings then could not come into play most of the time.
1109 However, some *other* time they might come into play, and *then* produce a hypo 1-2 hours
1110 later.

1111

1112 Therefore, **carefully study the AUTO ISF tab** (or better yet, do an **emulator** based analysis, see
1113 [sections 10-11](#)) to see

- 1114 • what the selected weights **would** do, **if** there was **no zero-tempering** at the time, and
- 1115 • whether you bump into a **set limit** already (if your bgAccel_ISF_weight makes you exceed
1116 allowed max. SMB size, then further tuning your settings only makes sense with either
1117 allowing bigger SMBs, or limiting bgAccel_ISF_weight to a lower number at which you will
1118 not frequently bounce into the SMB limit)
- 1119 • at which **other** times (rather than the one you currently look at and try to improve) that
1120 selected setting might backfire

1121

1122

1123 4.5.9 How your “UAM” loop concludes insulin need for your un-declared carbs

1124

1125 The UAM Full Closed Loop doesn't get any information from you as to how many grams of carbs
1126 will be there, for absorption.

1127

1128 Looking back

1129

1130 For the recent 5-minute segments, the UAM oref(1) loops can precisely calculate how many grams
1131 of carb “must have been digested” based on the CGM values seen, and your IC and ISF profile
1132 parameters

1133 For more detail see chapter 1.2 on how dynamic carb absorption is calculated, in “**Carb ratio** (IC,
1134 CIR)...pdf” at: <https://github.com/bernie4375/HCL-Meal-Mgt.-ISF-and-IC-settings>.

1135

1136 Looking into the next minutes, hour

1137

1138 However, *here* we worry about the *late meal stage*, and our FCL has gotten no information from us
1139 about how many grams **in total** were eaten, and certainly we do not bother to give eCarbs with
1140 estimated **absorption times** (that are so essential in iOS Loop).

1141

1142 So, in FCL you leave your loop without knowledge when your steady-state max carb absorption
1143 phase...

1144 ○ the earlier mentioned 30g/h, or

1145 ○ with gastroparesis, or if on GLP-1 drug treatment, probably on a lower g/h level

1146 ○ sometimes prolonged (“faked”) by a brief episode of insulin resistance to fats

1147 ...might end. Nor, whether extra carbs were added, later, or “FPU’s are lurking”.

1148

1149 The FCL now needs to provide desired amounts of insulin, while facing a potentially induced hypo
1150 danger later (considering the DIA of all the insulin still active).

1151

1152 Fortunately, the UAM Full Closed Loop is *not completely clueless* regarding how carb absorption
1153 *will continue*:

1154

1155 It will work with a **prediction** of *further* carb absorption, building on the **carb deviations**
1156 (=calculation of how much got absorbed in the *past* 5 minute segments), and phase out further
1157 *expected* carb decay in the course of the next 1 to max 3 hours.

1158

1159

1160 For more detail see

1161 • <https://openaps.readthedocs.io/en/latest/docs/While%20You%20Wait%20For%20Gear/Understand-determine-basal.html#understanding-the-basic-logic-written-version>

1162 • *or do a real-time study* with (screenshots from) your AUTO ISF tab info.

1164

1165 Discussion

1166 **This UAM prediction** about further carb absorption can be worse, but **can also be better than a**
1167 **prediction based on the user's „e-Carb“ input** as done in Hybrid Closed Loop.

1168

1169 In any case, and even when having perfect knowledge about how exactly the carbs fade out in the
1170 next hours, there would still be a principal problem for the loop: Heavy insulin „fire“ against highs
1171 will not work immediately (depending on the insulin's time-to-peak), and notably it comes with a
1172 significant hypo danger from the „tail“ of insulin activity.

1173 A big bolus, or also a series of boli, will rarely work exactly for several hours matching the
1174 absorption of carbs (from what, how much and and how fast the user ate).

1175

1176 *Off topic closing remark:* With meticulous attention to all carb-related profile parameters, and daily
1177 inputs on amounts and absorption times, plus some “mindfulness” as to which diet habits disturb the
1178 possible balance, there are “pro” loopers (notably on iOS Loop) who achieve impressive %TIR
1179 (and % in tight range) performance. –

1180 The author consciously chose the other way, to put substantial effort into a personalized upfront
1181 system calibration, and work with aoref(1) algo system that allows (nearly) every day hands-off FCL.

1182

1183 4.6 Tuning your initial settings

1184

1185 Be pro-active: **The earlier large SMBs come** (driven by bgAccel_ISF and pp_ISF) ...

1186 Note: Also your CGM smoothing may play a role here, that you may want to look into !

1187 ...the **less high** the overall increase in BG will be, and (provided you set a proper iobTH)
1188 the **lesser** the **risk** will be **for a hypo** after the meal.

1189

1190 Therefore, **put most of your FCL tuning effort into determining suitable weights for**
1191 **bgAccel_ and for pp_ISF, and for finding a suitable iobTH_percent.**

1192

1193 Low carbers probably should pay more attention on **dura_ISF**, besides seeing to it that
1194 bgAccel_ISF is not too aggressive (see above, [section 4.2.5](#) and [case study 4.2](#)).

1195

1196 Later, your “FCL cockpit” will give you access to **temporarily modulate** these essential
1197 parameters (see [section 5.2.](#)), providing you an opportunity

- 1198 • in your tuning phase, for more research on the fly, so to speak
- 1199 • everyday, for temp. adaptations to altered insulin sensitivity, or to special
1200 disturbances (should you, occasionally, see a need).

1201 After you tuned your **initial settings** well, there should rarely arise a need for “fine tuning” later,
1202 see [section 8](#) and [case study 8.2!](#)

1203
1204 The experience of the author is that it is possible to tune the above mentioned weights for very
1205 different meals in such a way that the glucose almost always remains acceptably in range.

1206 Pay attention also to bg and iob development, as you approach meal times (and what an
1207 appetizer could do, good or bad).

1208 However, if you come to the conclusion that **differentiated settings** (for different meals or meal
1209 time clusters) would be easier to establish, and/or work better for you, the following sections
1210 suggest many options you could try and use.

1211 #

1212

1213 4.7 Maneuvering through more complex scenarios

1214

1215 You now can move on, to accommodate more complex scenarios.

1216

1217 4.7.1 Complex meal spectrum

1218

- 1219 • Especially if you are a bit shy of using the Emulator ([section 10](#) and [11](#)) for really detailed
1220 analysis, it can well be that you will not hit *one* real good system calibration ([section 4](#)) for your
1221 *entire range* of diets (e.g. your *meal spectrum* at all your lunches).
 - 1222 ○ Note that *between meal time slots* (e.g. breakfasts vs lunches) you should differentiate
1223 via different “circadian” *profile_ISFs* (with which the autoISF-effects always multiply).
- 1224 • So, in case you occasionally run out of range (bg =70...180 mg/dl), your options to prevent,
1225 react, or improve are:
 - 1226 ○ accepting a few % higher time outside of range for that day (and, if feasible, in the
1227 future avoiding what seemed to have caused it)
 - 1228 ○ taking a snack (whenever you tend to go low from the “tails” of insulin activity that was
1229 required to fight a peak)

- 1230 ○ doing a manual “tweak” (if you can think of one in time), to manage the problem
- 1231 manually. For example, briefly going into an odd TT (=temp. blocking more SMBs) can
- 1232 be a very easy-to-handle remedy, sometimes
- 1233 ○ define a User Action Automation, and provide an extra “cockpit button” to announce a
- 1234 meal *outside of your usual spectrum*, so it will automatically be treated differently by
- 1235 your FCL (as you defined in your Automation; example: [Case study 5.2](#)).
- 1236 ○ temporarily resorting to “your old” hybrid closed loop.

1237

1238 Instead of accepting such instances, you could launch “improvement projects”, that refine your

1239 initial tuning ([section 4](#). and [sections 8](#) and [9](#))

1240

1241 Note, though, that it could be near-impossible to fine-tune *if your basics never were “right”* and you

1242 got lost in a maze of errors and counter-errors.

1243 In that case, **only a fresh start might convincingly help.**

1244

1245 4.7.2 Complex tasks aside from managing meals

1246

1247 To deal with *different* disturbances than presented by your meal spectrum (that you were

1248 calibrating for in this section 4), there will be **other** instances where **temporary modulations** of

1249 your FCL will be needed.

1250

1251 You have a variety of options to deal with that, and this will be the topic in [section 5](#).

1252

1253 It is suggested to do **major exercise** still *in your hybrid closed loop* setting, *until* you have your

1254 FCL up and running for meals on normal days with no or only moderate exercise.

1255 Later, implement extras as discussed in [section 6](#) to fully implement your FCL.

1256

1257

1258

4.8 Profile helper

DRAFT by John Kitching/edited

For general loop settings for FCL with autoISF, please consult [sections 2.1 – 2.6](#)

The following table gives a comprehensive approach how to tune your autoISF FCL better, when you see any of the problems as in *column A*.

Make sure to work through the problems in the order given in this table.

	A	B	C	D
1	Notes: 1. if not entering carbs then "several hours after eating" can be applied instead of "with zero COB"			
2	The problem (follow in order)	Y/N	Possible solution	Based on what logic
3	Are you having periods with zero COB and negative IOB?	Yes	Decrease basal a bit over these periods, wait a couple of days to evaluate and return here	Oref is backing off your basal to try and hold your BG steady so basal is probably too high
4		No	Continue with this sheet	
5	Are you having periods with zero COB and positive IOB?	Yes	Increase basal a bit over these periods, wait a couple of days to evaluate and return here	Oref is increasing your basal to try and hold your BG steady so basal is probably too low
6		No	Continue with this sheet	
7	Do you get roller coaster BGs?	Yes	Increase profile ISF a bit (make weaker). Also, check your set iobTH%. Reevaluate over a couple of days, return here	BG goes over target -> with too-strong ISF, too much insulin is dosed resulting in BG below target. Long zero-temping required, but resulting in high BG next ...
8		No	Continue with this sheet	
9	After your BG went high, do you get a hypo later (from remaining insulin "tail" at zero COB)?	Yes	Reduce autoISF "weights" a bit, reevaluate over a couple of days, return here	ISF is reduced (strengthened) too much by autoISF as you move away from target. Reducing the proper ISF_weight will reduce that impact. Use the autoISF history table for more information about which one is causing the issue: Preferably, "shave of late", at DURA or BG; PP or ACCEL weights might need reducing, too.
10		No	Continue with this sheet	
13	When you start eating with BG around target and iob near zero, do you get a hypo (in the first 2 hours)?	Yes	Check whether you can reduce your set iobTH%, or SMB range extension, or autoISFmax. Decrease PP (and maybe also ACCEL) "weight", and increase profile carb ratio a bit (make it weaker, so you see the insulin needed relate well to the g of carbs digested by the time you see a hypo tendency). Reevaluate over a couple of days, return here	You're getting too much insulin to cope with the bg rises from the carbs you've eaten. Taming the loop can be done in several ways: Weakening profile carb ratio and ISF would work in all situations. Lowering ACCEL and/or PP autoISF "weights" would exactly weaken loop over-response in early stage of BG rise. And the 3 first-mentioned safety settings just limit excesses.
14		No	Continue with this sheet	
17	When you eat, is iob building up too slow, with a lot of it added at bg peak or even still when BG reduces?	Yes	Check whether you must increase your set iobTH%, or SMB range extension, or autoISFmax. Increase PP "weight", and decrease profile carb ratio a bit (make it stronger, so you see the insulin needed relate well to the g of carbs digested). Reevaluate over a couple of days, return here	You're not getting enough insulin to cope with the bg rises from the carbs you've eaten. If your loop bounces into any of the 3 first-mentioned limits, "tuning more aggressive" might simply not work. Making the loop more aggressive can be done in several ways: Strengthening (lowering) profile carb ratio and ISF would work in all situations. Elevating autoISF "weights" (notably PP) could exactly strengthen loop response in instances where needed (where the respective "weight" is playing a role).
18		No	Continue with this sheet	
19	Does BG stay high for long periods?	Yes	Increase DURA "weight" a bit. Reevaluate over a couple of days, return here	DURA reduces ISF (makes it stronger) if BG stays high for longer periods than it should. Reminder: Follow this sheet in order ! This "last job", dealing with persistent highs via DURA, is much easier after you sorted out how to build-up iob faster, so not to go super high in the first place.
20		No	Have a short holiday with lots of carbs	
22	Further reading:			
23	Ga-zelle's quick start guide		https://github.com/ga-zelle/autoISF/blob/A3.2.0.4_ai3.0.1/autoISF3.0.1_Quick_Guide.pdf	
	FCL e-Book, Trouble Shooting		https://github.com/bernie4375/FCL-potential-autoISF/blob/FCL-e-book/09_Trouble.Shooting_FCL-	